

Module 3 - Writing Hooks That Catch

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Introduction ►

In this video I'm going to teach you all about **hooks**.

A **hook** is the first thing someone sees or hears in your video ads, and it decides whether they stop scrolling or ignore you completely.

This is usually going to be the first 1-2 lines of speech in your video ads but could also be the main title in a graphic, or first line or two of text in an ad depending on what format you are using.

It doesn't matter how good your offer is or how strong your angle is. If the **hook** doesn't earn attention no one will see the rest of the ad.

In this lesson I'm going to show you what a **hook** actually is, what its job is, and why most **hooks** fail.

We'll break down the difference between good **hooks** and bad **hooks**, how to avoid **curiosity** clickbait that attracts the wrong people, and the common mistakes that kill ad performance.

I'll also show you how to turn the ad angles you've already mapped out into clear, effective **hooks**, using simple formulas you can apply over and over again.

The goal is to create **hooks** that immediately tell the right person, "this is for you", and give Meta the clear signals it needs to find more people like them.

By the end of this video, you should be able to look at any angle and confidently turn it into multiple **hooks** that catch attention and set your ads up for success.

What Is A Hook 🎣

Put simply: your **hook** is the opening of your ad and its job is to earn a few seconds of attention from the right person.

It's not your headline and it's not about trying to be clever, shocking or entertaining.

I want you to look at **hooks** as filters. A good **hook** doesn't try to attract everyone. It tries to quickly attract the right person and repel everyone else.

It quickly tells the viewer:

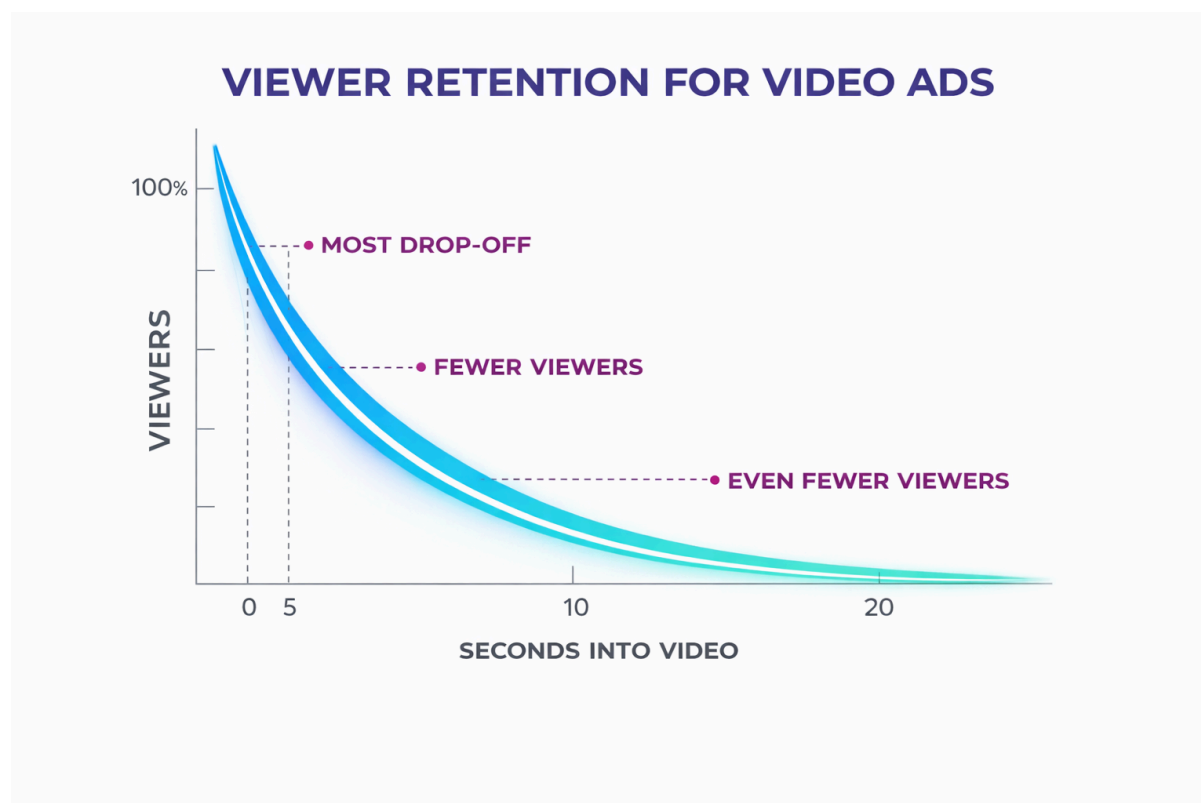
- What this ad is about
- Who it's for
- Why they should keep watching

The **hook** is the most important part of your creative.

If the **hook** does its job properly the right people stick around for the full ad.

If it doesn't they could potentially be scrolling past and the rest of the ad won't have any chance to perform.

Think of it like the cover of a book. It needs to catch the attention of the reader and give them an idea of what the book is about. If it doesn't they won't open it and read it.



The Job Of A Hook

Hooks have two main jobs to achieve.

- **Clarity:** The viewer to immediately understand what the ad is about
- **Curiosity:** The viewer feels like this is relevant to them and worth their attention.

If you have **curiosity** without **clarity**, people are confused.

If you have **clarity** without **curiosity**, people are bored.

By using a strong **hook** we balance both. It makes the viewer think:

“This is about my problem.”

“And this might actually help me.”

Why Hooks Matter On Meta

Hooks are absolutely essential to ad performance on Meta.

This is because Meta looks at how people respond to your ad in the first few seconds.

- Who stops.
- Who watches.
- Who engages.
- Who leaves immediately.

Those early reactions tell Meta who your ad is relevant to and teaches it who to show your ads to next.

This is why it's so important to make sure our Hooks are attracting the right people, and filtering out people we don't want.

For instance, if we had a hook that was 'clickbaity' and drove a lot of curiosity but had no clarity we could have a lot of irrelevant clicks.

This in turn provides bad feedback to the algorithm.

In short:

- Your angle decides who the ad is for.
- Your hook decides whether they pay attention.

If your hook is weak the angle never gets a chance.

Common Hook Mistakes ❌

Most hooks fail for one of four main reasons.

If you can identify which one is happening then fixing it becomes really obvious.

You don't need to be clever, just keep it simple and avoid these four mistakes.

1. Delay ⌚

Delay happens when the hook takes too long to introduce what the ad is actually about.

The first line is vague, emotional, or "warming up" instead of giving context.

Examples of delay:

"This is one of the craziest things I've ever seen..."



“You won’t believe what happened when...”

These lines create **curiosity**, but they give the viewer no information to decide if they should keep watching.

Lots of videos you see online suffer from this issue and now you are aware of it you will likely see it everywhere.

On Meta, those first 1–2 seconds matter most. Every second without **clarity** causes people to scroll past.

Why this kills performance:

If the viewer doesn’t know what the video is about immediately, they can’t decide to opt in.

Curiosity without context = uncertainty.

Uncertainty = scrolling.

How to fix it:

Make sure you introduce the topic in the first sentence

- Cut fluff.
- Cut warm-ups
- Increase your speed to value.

Good examples:

“If you’re struggling to lose weight, this is why it keeps coming back.”

“Here are three simple ways to lose fat without living in the gym.”

2. Confusion ?

What this looks like

The **hook** introduces the topic, but the wording is unclear, overcomplicated, or awkward.

The viewer hears the words, but doesn’t fully understand what you mean.

This usually happens when:

- Sentences are too long
- Too many ideas are packed into one line
- Passive or abstract language is used

For example:



“This business owner doubled their appointments using a 30 day process that is impossible to learn unless you have a AI appointment setter like they did”

Why this kills performance:

If the viewer can't quickly understand the **hook**, they can't assess relevance.

If they have to “think” to understand it, they won't.

Confusion creates friction, and friction kills retention.

How to fix it:

We need to make sure we are writing for **clarity** and not to be clever.

- Use simple language
- Use fewer words
- Use active voice
- Aim for a 6th-grade reading level

Our example could now read something like:

“This business owner doubled their monthly appointments in just 30 days using this AI appointment setter”

Quick test:

Read your **hook** in isolation.

If it could be interpreted in more than one way, or it doesn't have immediate meaning.
Rewrite it.

3. Irrelevance 🙄

Irrelevance happens when the **hook** is clear, but the viewer doesn't feel confident the video is for them.

They understand the topic, but they're unsure if what's coming next will actually help their situation.

This often happens when **hooks** are framed around:

“I” and “me”

This happens when we focus on the creator's story instead of the viewer's problem or, use generic statements instead of specific pain points.



Why this kills performance:

If the viewer doesn't see themselves in the **hook**, they won't invest attention.

They ask themselves:

"Is this actually relevant to me?"

If the answer isn't immediately "yes", they scroll.

How to fix it:

Frame **hooks** around the viewer.

- Use "you" and "your"
- Call out the situation or problem directly
- Make the expected value obvious

Example:

Instead of

"I struggled with weight loss for years..."

Use

*"If **you** struggle with weight loss..."*

4. Disinterest 🙄

This happens when the **hook** is clear and relevant, but it doesn't create enough **curiosity** to keep someone watching.

The viewer understands what the video is about and who it's for, but there's no reason to stay.

This usually happens when the **hook**:

- States a fact without tension
- Feels obvious or generic
- Lacks **contrast**

Why this kills performance:

Clarity and relevance get attention.

Curiosity keeps it.



Without **curiosity**, the viewer has no reason to continue.

How to fix it:

Create **contrast**.

Contrast is the distance between:

What they currently believe or have tried and a better, faster, or more effective alternative

This can be:

Stated **contrast**

*“Most people try **strict diets**, but this approach actually lasts.”*

Implied **contrast**

*“This is the **easiest** way to lose weight without burning out.”*

Contrast makes the viewer ask “Why is this different?”.

That question keeps them watching.

If we take our example:

“This business owner doubled their monthly appointments in 30 days using an AI appointment setter.”

It's clear but it doesn't challenge anything yet. We can add **contrast** to make it stronger.

Step 1 - We want to show the baseline belief.

Business owners believe that to get more appointments, they need:

- More ads
- Better funnels
- More manual follow-ups
- More time chasing leads

Step 2 - Introduce the **contrast**

A = “run more ads”

B = “AI appointment setter”

We can state it directly:

“Most business owners try to book more calls by running more ads.

You can double your monthly appointments in 30 days using an AI appointment setter instead.”

Or, we can imply it and leave them to fill in the gaps.

“This business owner doubled their monthly appointments in 30 days, without running more ads by using an AI appointment setter.”

What’s happening here:

- You never explain the old way
- The viewer fills in the gap themselves
- Their brain asks: “Wait... then how?”

The **contrast** is doing the work.

Hook Structure

In most high-performing **hooks**, **contrast** lives in the second sentence, not the first.

Keep the first sentence's job as **clarity** and the second sentence's job as **curiosity**.

If you try to do both at once, **hooks** often become confusing, wordy, or unbelievable.

Tell me what it's about > Give me a reason to keep watching.

To keep things simple you can use the following formula.

Sentence 1 → Topic Clarity

Tell the viewer exactly what the video is about.

Sentence 2 → Contrast (Curiosity)

Challenge what they already believe or introduce a better alternative.

What’s Next

In the next lesson, we’re going to take the angles you’ve already mapped out and turn them into **hooks**.

I’m going to give you my simple step by step formula that you can reuse across every offer and every client so you always have a clear path from onboarding to execution.



Summary ✓

A **hook** has one job: earn a few seconds of attention from the right person and give Meta the signal it needs to find more people like them.

It is not about being clever or shocking. It is about **clarity** and **curiosity** working together — the first sentence tells the viewer what the ad is about, the second gives them a reason to keep watching.

The four mistakes that kill **hooks** are delay, confusion, irrelevance, and disinterest. Delay buries the topic. Confusion forces the viewer to think. Irrelevance fails to signal who the ad is for. Disinterest gives no reason to stay. Fix any one of these and performance improves immediately.

In the next lesson we are going to take everything here and put it into practice — turning the angles you have already mapped out into **hooks** using a simple, repeatable framework.